Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · GROW · Spring 2 Week 2 · Monday 1 March 2027 · P6

Lesson

Test a skill for a short performance

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Develop drama or music skills for performance.

Today I can

I can try two versions of one skill.

I can explain a choice for a short piece.

I can set a small practice goal.

Prepare

For up to five pupils: one book or arts log and pencil each.

Two invented performance example cards and the short original Keeper lines.

A clear space for pairs or one group of three; seated work is valid.

Hands or fingertips only for optional soft taps; no instrument, playback or device is needed.

Keep the actual trials, chosen feature and practice goal for Wednesday.

Cover route

Read and demonstrate the two invented examples, then let pupils choose drama or a quiet original sound pattern. Teach one skill test with two versions and a small goal. Work in pairs or a three with performer, director and listener turns. Keep the genuine trial and goal for Wednesday. Offer silent and private routes throughout.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: Our half-term theme is Resilience & Change. The Keeper's table has moved. We can show a small change through drama or a new sound pattern. Choose a route and agree the quiet stop signal. We are not sharing real personal changes.

Look for: Every pupil chooses a route and an access method. Noise and space agreements are explicit.

Fallback: Offer a silent hand scene or pupil-directed adult trial. A sound route may be planned and directed without pupil-made sound.

Check and response: Either art form is valid. A pupil may change route after the first test; record the route actually used.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: I say "The table has moved. I can ask for help" with and without a pause. Or I tap four quiet beats twice, with a gap before the second set. Name what changed, without deciding what it must mean.

Look for: Pupils notice pace, a gap, stillness or a turn cue and distinguish observation from a possible meaning.

Fallback: Use silent finger pulses with a held hand for the gap. Point to gap or no gap.

Check and response: A pause is an observable feature. "It seems thoughtful to me" is an interpretation. Ask the maker about their intention.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: Read both fictional examples. Demonstrate the drama pause and the sound pattern quietly. My chosen skill is a clear pause. I test one silent count, then two. I choose two so the change is easier to notice. Check after the model: what stayed the same, and what changed?

Look for: Adult models one variable and a reasoned choice. Pupils identify that the gap length changed while the line or pattern was held stable.

Fallback: Demonstrate both gaps with hand pulses. Ask pupil to choose one or two silent counts; adult follows the choice.

Check and response: The gap changed from one count to two. The other words or beats stayed the same. A longer gap is a choice, not always an improvement.

We do 6 minutes

Say: In a pair or group of three, agree one choice. For drama, use the Keeper line and test the pause before asking for help. For sound, test the gap between two four-tap groups. Hinge: if we change pace, gap and loudness together, can we tell which helped? Choose one feature to test. If unclear, I hold everything except the gap stable and we compare again.

Look for: Pupils test one skill at a time and choose with a feature-based reason. Every pupil has a performer, director or listener turn.

Fallback: Adult performs the two versions under pupils' direction. Use silent cues and accept pointing for the reason.

Check and response: Changing one feature makes comparison easier. A useful reason is: the two-count gap made the change easier to hear. Do not require the same interpretation from every pupil.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Drama: use up to three short original lines about the changed table, with one move or still pause. Sound: create a short pattern of soft taps or silent movements with a planned gap and return. Test one feature twice. A partner describes one feature they noticed. Choose a version, explain why and set a measurable goal such as "hold a two-count pause twice" or "start after the cue twice". Pupils may work in pairs, a three or privately with an adult.

Look for: Each pupil has two actual trials, one chosen skill and reason, and a small practice goal. Original sound uses no copied tune or lyrics. Directions are retained when an adult performs.

Fallback: Choose between one and two silent counts. Adult follows the direction for both trials. Pupil confirms the chosen version and goal; record the evidence as direction.

Check and response: Example only: I tried one and two silent counts. I chose two to separate the changed plan from the new plan. My goal is to hold that pause in two runs. Do not enter this as a pupil's completed evidence.

Review 5 minutes

Say: A whole-class performance is optional. Share a brief section or direct the adult. The listener names a visible or heard feature. The maker can accept, adapt or keep their choice. Use the last two minutes to store dated plans and clear the working area.

Look for: The pupil's intended effect and practice goal remain their own. The real trial and note are preserved.

Fallback: Adult names the observed feature without judgement, then reads the pupil's reason back for confirmation.

Check and response: Useful feedback identifies a skill: the gap lasted two counts. Avoid diagnosing a character or pupil's feelings.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Complete the arts log or confirm an adult note. List your two versions, chosen feature and goal. Say if you performed, directed or listened and chose. Keep an honest gap where something was not tried; we can plan a real next step.

Look for: Dated log includes actual art form, trials, skill choice, reason, measurable next goal and accurate support.

Fallback: Adult prompts one item at a time and records exact confirmed words or gesture choices. No recording device is needed.

Check: Example only: I directed a quiet sound pattern with a two-count gap. Next lesson I will cue the return twice. Today's note records direction, not sound performed by the pupil.

Evidence and review

Keep a dated arts-log entry and a precise observation of a real trial. Record what the pupil performed or directed, the chosen feature, reason, feedback and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional and follows local consent procedures. No supplied teacher model counts as pupil evidence.

Misconceptions

Every test must change the whole piece - Change one feature to compare its effect. Keep a note of the two actual trials.

Music needs a tune or instrument - An original pattern of quiet beats and silence can be explored as sound. Silent movement is an access route.

More sound makes the change clearer - Pace, silence, order and a clear cue can carry the idea without louder sound.

Questions

foundation: Where is the pause or gap?

middle: What changed between your two trials?

higher: How will you know if your skill goal has been met?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Clear a small working space. Keep both feet supported if seated. Use hands within each person's own space. No touching another performer or taking a prop from them. Sound is optional; stop on the agreed signal. Pupils can direct the adult to perform their chosen pace and movement. Record that as directed evidence, not a vocal or physical skill the pupil personally demonstrated.

Emotional and sensory access

Use the invented changed-table story. No personal story is needed. Offer seated movement, silent direction, a private adult audience and a pass on live peer performance. Voice and taps stay at talking level or below. Agree an open-hand stop signal and quiet return cue. No sudden sounds, contact, running, raised platforms, blindfolds or lifts.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Pre-teach role, pace, pause and choice with a brief model. Show one instruction at a time. Offer two pace choices, rehearse once, then fade the prompt. Use a tiny plan with beginning, change and response.

Communication And Interaction: Give processing time. Accept pointing to a pace word, signing, a phrase, a sketch or exact words scribed by an adult. Read the record back for confirmation. Do not judge accent, eye contact or facial expression.

Semh: Keep the story fictional and low stakes. A pause, a change in method or a request for help can be the character's response. Let pupils choose the role, amount of performance and audience. Follow the agreed pause-and-return route.

Sensory And Physical: Offer seated hand movement and no sound. A pupil may direct an adult voice or movement. Keep each person in their own space; use no compulsory facial expression or posture. Ask before handling a pupil's work.

Eal: Plan in any language. Explain pace as how fast we speak or move. Accept first planning in a familiar language and check the intended meaning before adding English labels. The pupil may use a short English phrase or direct a partner.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. The lesson contributes evidence towards the award; it does not confer the award. Optional next level work in GROW adds skills planning, reflection and sharing evidence for later review. It is not a separate requirement for Explore success.

Resilience can mean pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying again. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or performing through pain.

Optional next level stretch

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Task

Set a specific skill goal for two rehearsal runs. Decide who could listen and what feedback you want on that skill. Explain why that audience can help. You can speak, sketch or write.

Evidence

Keep your own goal, two actual trials and audience plan. Record feedback only when it has really happened; a plan is labelled as a plan.

Optional scope

These additional planning and skills records may support later work at the next level. They are optional for this Explore lesson and do not certify a whole level of the award.

Support

Pupil selects a measurable goal, links it to a real trial and gives a reason for the chosen audience or feedback question.

The adult uses the same prompts, performs under the pupil's direction if needed, and records exact confirmed choices and actual support.